

Purism

Between 1918 and 1925, a new movement was developed in France by the painter Amédée Ozenfant (1886–1966) and the architect and painter Le Corbusier (Charles-Édouard Jeanneret). Feeling that Cubism had lost its original decisiveness and purity, they proposed a kind of austere painting that stripped objects of detail. Attempting to create a timeless, classical quality, Purism embraced new technologies and the modern machine age.

The two artists wrote about their ideas in a 1918 book, *Après le Cubisme*, and from 1920 to 1925 published a magazine *L'Esprit Nouveau*, exploring contemporary art, promoting Purism. They also presented ideas about architecture and town planning, denouncing past styles. A Purist manifesto stressed the importance of clarity, serenity and economy of means. Purism reached a climax in Le Corbusier's 1925 *Pavillon de l'Esprit Nouveau* at the International Exposition of Decorative and Industrial Arts in Paris, where work was exhibited by him, Ozenfant and the Cubists Léger, Gris and Jacques Lipchitz (1891–1973).



Ozenfant, *The White Pitcher*, 1925